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TAB 30



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-051-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/10/2026**In Control:** Board of Education

Dr. Rivas - Commemorating Bayard Rustin and Recognizing His Legacy as a Civil Rights and Labor Leader (Res-051-25/26) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (District) serves a diverse student population and is committed to providing an inclusive and historically accurate education that reflects the full contributions of Black leaders, LGBTQ+ leaders, labor organizers, and other individuals whose work has strengthened American democracy;

Whereas, Bayard Rustin was a principal architect of the 20th century civil rights movement whose leadership and organizing were foundational to advancing racial justice, economic justice, labor rights, and nonviolent democratic action, yet whose contributions were often minimized because he was openly gay;

Whereas, In the 1940s, Rustin organized the “Journey of Reconciliation,” laying the groundwork for the Freedom Rides, and later served as the chief organizer of the 1963 March on Washington for jobs and freedom alongside Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.;

Whereas, Rustin’s life and work demonstrate the interconnected struggles for racial justice, labor rights, LGBTQ+ equality, and democratic participation that remain central to civic education; and

Whereas, In 2013, President Barack Obama awarded Rustin a posthumous Presidential Medal of Freedom, acknowledging that he had long been denied his rightful place as a civil rights icon; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby proclaims March 17 of each year as Bayard Rustin Day in the District;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent or designee is directed to encourage schools to commemorate Bayard Rustin Day through age-appropriate educational activities aligned with state standards and the District’s existing curricular frameworks;

Resolved further, That the District shall ensure that Bayard Rustin’s contributions to civil rights, labor organizing, nonviolent democratic action, and LGBTQ+ equality are appropriately reflected in relevant U.S. History and Ethnic Studies curriculum; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Superintendent or designee shall explore appropriate opportunities, consistent with Board policy and community engagement processes, to further honor Bayard Rustin’s legacy within the District, including consideration of naming opportunities.